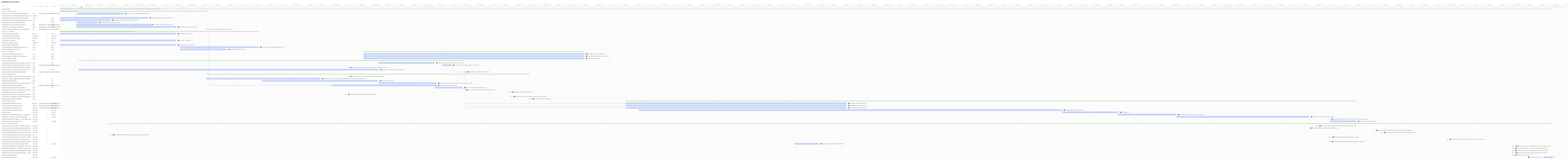

Tara Middlebrooks PhD Timeline

Finalize committee — obtain formal agreement from all 3 members
Complete RCR (Responsible Conduct of Research) Online Training
Identify and approach potential committee members (need 3 total: chair + 2)
Create Draft Electronic Plan of Study (EPOS) via myPurdue
Submit Draft EPOS to advisor and committee for signatures
File Final EPOS via myPurdue (due end of Semester 2)
Complete CITI Certification (citiprogram.org — human subjects ethics)
TECH 60300 (Lecture Graduate Seminar)
CNIT 57000DIST IT Data Analytics
TECH 676 (Analysis of Research methods)
EDCI 62100 (Technology for Qualitative Research) Summer 2026
EDCI 61500 (Qualitative Research Meth in Ed)
EDPS 55600DIST (Quantitative Data Analysis in Ed I)
EDPS 53000 (Learning and Cognition) or Human Learning and AI
TLI 66200 (Philosophy of Technology)
Complete Written Component of Preliminary Examination (2–4 week window)
Complete Oral Component of Preliminary Examination (min 2-hour block)
File GS Form 8 (Request to Appoint Examining Committee) via myPurdue — 3 members (within weekend)
Review all coursework — prepare for written + oral prelim components
Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coordinator
Add 4th Committee Member — update committee via EPOS Change Request (within weekend)
Draft Chapter 1: Introduction (Problem, Research Questions, Significance, Purpose, Assumptions, Limitations, Delimitations)
Draft Chapter 2: Review of Literature
Draft Chapter 3: Methodology (research design, data collection, instrument validation, analysis plan)
Submit IRB Application with CITI certificate attached
Advisor reviews and approves full proposal draft (Chapters 1–3)
Distribute proposal to all 4 committee members (required 2 weeks before defense)
Proposal Defense Meeting (30–40 min presentation + Q&A)
Schedule Proposal Defense Meeting — confirm date/room with all 4 members
File Polytechnic Form 2: Acceptance of Graduate Proposal (signed by all committee members)
Receive IRB Approval (monitor submission status)
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 1
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 2
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 3
Execute Data Collection (per IRB-approved protocol)
Execute Data Analysis
Write Chapter 4: Presentation of Data (findings only — no interpretation)
Write Chapter 5: Conclusions, Discussion, and Recommendations
Compile full dissertation draft (all 5 chapters + cover page, abstract, definitions, references, appendices)
Advisor reviews and approves full dissertation draft
Declare Graduation Candidacy — register for CAND 99100 via myPurdue (requires concurrent TECH 699)
Schedule Thesis Format Advising Appointment (email fanderso@purdue.edu)
Email complete dissertation to Polytechnic Thesis Format Advisor 2 days before advising appointment
Attend Thesis Format Advising Meeting (review iThenticate report; get GS Form 9 signed)
Final Oral Examination / Dissertation Defense (30–45 min public presentation + closed committee Q&A)
File GS Form 8 (Final Examining Committee) via myPurdue — 4 members
Distribute advisor-approved dissertation to all 4 committee members + Assoc. Dean for Grad Studies
Schedule University Deposit Meeting with Graduate School (book electronically — slots fill fast)
Complete required revisions to dissertation per committee feedback
Attend University Deposit Meeting — submit dissertation + GS Form 9, GS Form 9 ETD, GS Form 32
Submit Polytechnic College Deposit — upload to Purdue e-Pubs (docs.lib.purdue.edu/tech/)
Provide final dissertation copies to committee (digital preferred; printed/bound if chair requests)
Complete Graduate School Exit Survey (required for graduation — notified via myPurdue)
Complete Survey of Earned Doctorate
Commencement / Hooding Ceremony

Name	Due Date	Dependenc…	Priority	Start Date
Dissertation Timeline				
Phase 1 — Program Setup & Admin				
Finalize committee — obtain formal agreement from all 3 members	Apr 17	Submit Draft EPOS to advisor and committee for signa		Mar 24
Meet with Major Professor — confirm advisor assignment, discuss researc…	Oct 1 2025	-		
Complete RCR (Responsible Conduct of Research) Online Training	Apr 30	-		Jan 12
Identify and approach potential committee members (need 3 total: chair + 2)	Apr 10	-		Mar 10
Create Draft Electronic Plan of Study (EPOS) via myPurdue	Apr 3	-		Mar 24
Submit Draft EPOS to advisor and committee for signatures	May 1	Finalize committee — obtain formal agreement from al		Mar 24
File Final EPOS via myPurdue (due end of Semester 2)	May 15	Submit Draft EPOS to advisor and committee for signa		Mar 24
Complete CITI Certification (citiprogram.org — human subjects ethics)	Jun 1	Submit IRB Application with CITI certificate attached		
Phase 2 — Year 1 Coursework				
TECH 60300 (Lecture Graduate Seminar)	May 15	-		Jan 12
CNIT 51900 (Natural Language Technologies)	Dec 20 2025	-		Aug 25 2025
CNIT 61700 (Cyber Physical Security Seminar)	Dec 20 2025	-		Aug 25 2025
CNIT 57000DIST IT Data Analytics	May 15	-		Jan 12
EDCI 55201 (AI Integration in Education)	Dec 20 2025	-		Aug 25 2025
TECH 676 (Analysis of Research methods)	May 15	-		Jan 12
EDCI 62100 (Technology for Qualitative Research) Summer 2026	Jun 28	-		May 18
EDCI 61500 (Qualitative Research Meth in Ed)	Jun 11	-		May 18
Phase 3 — Year 2 Coursework				
EDPS 55600DIST (Quantitative Data Analysis in Ed I)	Dec 19	-		Aug 24
EDPS 53000 (Learning and Cognition) or Human Learning and AI	Dec 19	-		Aug 24
TLI 66200 (Philosophy of Technology)	Dec 19	-		Aug 24
Phase 4 — Preliminary Examination				
Complete Written Component of Preliminary Examination (2–4 week windo…	Sep 30	-		Sep 1
Complete Oral Component of Preliminary Examination (min 2-hour block)	Oct 9	Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coo		Oct 5
File GS Form 8 (Request to Appoint Examining Committee) via myPurdue …	Aug 15	-		
Review all coursework — prepare for written + oral prelim components	Aug 31	-		Mar 25
Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coordinator	Oct 16	Complete Oral Component of Preliminary Examination		
Phase 5 — Dissertation Proposal				
Add 4th Committee Member — update committee via EPOS Change Requ…	Aug 15	-		
Draft Chapter 1: Introduction (Problem, Research Questions, Significance, …	Jul 31	-		Jun 1
Draft Chapter 2: Review of Literature	Aug 31	-		Jul 1
Draft Chapter 3: Methodology (research design, data collection, instrument…	Oct 1	-		Sep 1
Submit IRB Application with CITI certificate attached	Oct 1	Complete CITI Certification (citiprogram.org — human		Aug 7
Advisor reviews and approves full proposal draft (Chapters 1–3)	Oct 15	-		Oct 1
Distribute proposal to all 4 committee members (required 2 weeks before d…	Oct 16	-		
Proposal Defense Meeting (30–40 min presentation + Q&A)	Nov 9	-		
Schedule Proposal Defense Meeting — confirm date/room with all 4 memb…	Aug 14	-		
File Polytechnic Form 2: Acceptance of Graduate Proposal (signed by all c…	Nov 10	-		
Receive IRB Approval (monitor submission status)	Nov 20	-		
Phase 6 — Research & Writing				
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 1	May 8 2027	Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coo		Jan 11 2027
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 2	May 8 2027	Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coo		Jan 11 2027
TECH 69900 (Dissertation Research) Spring 2027 3	May 8 2027	Verify candidacy status with Polytechnic Graduate Coo		Jan 11 2027
Execute Data Collection (per IRB-approved protocol)	Aug 31 2027	-		Jan 18 2027
Execute Data Analysis	Sep 30 2027	-		Sep 1 2027
Write Chapter 4: Presentation of Data (findings only — no interpretation)	Oct 31 2027	-		Oct 1 2027
Write Chapter 5: Conclusions, Discussion, and Recommendations	Jan 10 2028	-		Nov 1 2027
Compile full dissertation draft (all 5 chapters + cover page, abstract, definiti…	Jan 21 2028	-		
Advisor reviews and approves full dissertation draft	Feb 4 2028	-		Jan 22 2028
Phase 7 — Final Defense & Graduation				
Declare Graduation Candidacy — register for CAND 99100 via myPurdue …	Jan 14 2028	-		
Schedule Thesis Format Advising Appointment (email fanderso@purdue.e…	Jan 10 2028	-		
Email complete dissertation to Polytechnic Thesis Format Advisor 2 days b…	Feb 14 2028	-		
Attend Thesis Format Advising Meeting (review iThenticate report; get GS …	Feb 18 2028	-		
Final Oral Examination / Dissertation Defense (30–45 min public presentati…	Apr 10	-		
File GS Form 8 (Final Examining Committee) via myPurdue — 4 members	Jan 21 2028	-		
Distribute advisor-approved dissertation to all 4 committee members + Ass…	Mar 24 2028	-		
Schedule University Deposit Meeting with Graduate School (book electroni…	Jan 21 2028	-		
Complete required revisions to dissertation per committee feedback	Apr 23 2027	-		Apr 11 2027
Attend University Deposit Meeting — submit dissertation + GS Form 9, GS…	Apr 28 2028	-		
Submit Polytechnic College Deposit — upload to Purdue e-Pubs (docs.lib.…	Apr 28 2028	-		
Provide final dissertation copies to committee (digital preferred; printed/bo…	Apr 28 2028	-		
Complete Graduate School Exit Survey (required for graduation — notified…	Apr 28 2028	-		
Complete Survey of Earned Doctorate	Apr 28 2028	-		
Commencement / Hooding Ceremony	May 19 2028	-		May 15 2028